■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Monday, October 05, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *Fox News Personality Makes Surprising Claim About ‘Sesame Street’: ‘They Get Super Political’*

The Angle: *A Fox News personality just dragged beloved kids' show Sesame Street into the culture war, and that's instant watercooler fodder - everyone has nostalgia for Big Bird, so a 'they've gone political' claim is guaranteed to split the room.*

- A **Fox News personality** publicly claimed **'Sesame Street'** has **'gotten super political'**
- The remark is sparking debate online over whether a kids' show is being politicized

The Debate Starter

- Have you actually noticed Sesame Street getting political, or is this just outrage for clicks?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://parade.com/entertainment/fox-news-personality-makes-surprising-claim-about-sesame-street-they-get-super-political

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■ *The surprising names Prince George, Princess Charlotte and Prince Louis go by at school*

The Angle: *The royals famously ditch the titles at school gates, and now Prince George, Princess Charlotte and Prince Louis are reportedly doing the same with their own low-key school names — a fun peek at how hard the family works to keep the kids' lives normal.*

- **Prince George** just started his **first year at Eton College**, the same school his dad **Prince William** attended.
- His younger siblings, **Princess Charlotte** and **Prince Louis**, are both at **Lambrook Prep School**.
- Royal schools have a long history of having the kids use low-key surnames instead of 'Prince' or 'Princess' to blend in with classmates.

The Debate Starter

- Would you want your kid known by a secret 'normal' name at school if you were famous, or is that just extra confusing for a 12-year-old?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/05/royal-family/suprising-names-prince-george-princess-charlotte-and-prince-louis-go-by-at-school/

■ *Stephen Colbert’s ‘Lord of the Rings’ Movie Reportedly ‘Paused’ Over Paramount-Warner Bros. Merger*

The Angle: *Stephen Colbert's passion-project trip to Middle-earth is reportedly on ice, caught in the crossfire of the Paramount-Warner Bros. merger chaos — a fun 'who actually controls Hollywood right now' story.*

- **Stephen Colbert**'s **Lord of the Rings** movie has reportedly been **'paused'**
- The holdup is tied to the ongoing **Paramount-Warner Bros.** merger shakeup
- It's the latest project caught in limbo as the two studios sort out their future

The Water-Cooler Take

- Does a corporate merger really get to put Middle-earth on hold?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/stephen-colberts-lord-of-the-rings-movie-reportedly-paused-over-paramount-warner-bros-merger-2000821429

■ *Google Is Accused of Destroying Nearly 500 Football Fields of Forest for New Data Center Project*

The Angle: *Google's getting called out for clear-cutting nearly 500 football fields of forest to build a new data center - it's the AI boom's environmental cost showing up in a very real, very visual way, and that's a tension audiences are already primed to argue about.*

- **Google** is accused of clearing roughly **500 football fields** worth of forest.
- The land was cleared to make way for a new **data center** project.

The Debate Starter

- Is unlimited AI growth worth paving over forests to get it?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gadgetreview.com/google-is-accused-of-destroying-nearly-500-football-fields-of-forest-for-new-data-center-project

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■■ *It's election day in Quebec: What you need to know to vote*

The Angle: *Quebecers hit the polls today to decide who runs the province next, and the outcome could ripple into national politics well beyond Quebec's borders.*

- Today is **October 5**, official election day across **Quebec**.
- Voters are choosing who leads the **next provincial government**.
- Polls determine the province's **political direction** going forward.

The Debate Starter

- Does what happens in Quebec today actually matter to the rest of us, or is it strictly a local story?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/montreal/quebec-provincial-election-voting-day-2026-9.7364241?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor challenges validity of search warrants in his Epstein-related arrest*

The Angle: *The disgraced royal isn't just denying the Epstein document allegations anymore — he's taking police to court over how they arrested him, keeping this scandal very much alive and giving hosts a fresh legal angle to dig into.*

- **Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor** is challenging the validity of the **search warrants** used in his **February arrest**
- He was arrested on suspicion of **misconduct in public office**
- The allegation: he sent **confidential government documents** to **Jeffrey Epstein**
- He's taking the case to court rather than letting the arrest stand unchallenged

The Debate Starter

- Is this a smart legal move to clear his name, or does fighting the warrant just make him look guiltier?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/andrew-arrest-epstein-legal-challenge-9.7369171?cmp=rss

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CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Alberta separatists' talks with GOP spark outcry, call for legislative change*

The Angle: *Word that Alberta's independence movement has been in talks with Republican figures south of the border is setting off alarm bells, and now there's a push to change the law because of it - that's a real "wait, what?" story for a Canadian audience.*

- **Alberta separatists** are reportedly in contact with figures tied to the **GOP** in the U.S.
- The news has sparked outcry from critics who see foreign involvement in a Canadian independence push as a red line.
- There are now calls for a **legislative change** to address or restrict this kind of cross-border political contact.

The Debate Starter

- Should it be illegal for a U.S. political party to be chatting up a Canadian separatist movement?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/canada/article-alberta-separatists-talks-with-gop-spark-call-for-change-from-calgary/

■ *Poilievre team divided over when to drop Mark Carney diss track*

The Angle: *Canadian politics colliding with meme culture is always good radio - the idea that Pierre Poilievre's team is strategizing the rollout of an actual diss track aimed at Mark Carney says a lot about how modern political attacks are being packaged for social media.*

The Debate Starter

- Smart campaign move or beneath the office - would a political diss track actually change your vote, or is it just cringe?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/10/poilievre-team-divided-over-when-to-drop-mark-carney-diss-track/

❄■ *Cold reality: Canadian troops struggle in Alaska as military relearns Arctic warfare*

The Angle: *Canadian troops training alongside the US in Alaska are reportedly struggling with brutal Arctic conditions - a reality check as climate change and global tensions put the North Pole region back on the map strategically.*

- **Canadian troops** took part in joint military exercises in **Alaska**
- Report describes a **"cold reality"** - soldiers and the military broadly having to relearn **Arctic warfare** skills
- Comes as the Arctic becomes a bigger focus for defense planners amid melting ice and rising global interest in the region

The Debate Starter

- Is Canada actually ready to defend its own backyard up north?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/arctic-warfare-canada-troops-training-9.7367626?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *'Unintended consequences': Poll shows UCP independence referendum boosting Alberta NDP*

The Angle: *Premier Danielle Smith leaned into an independence referendum to keep her party's base happy, but new polling suggests it's spooking moderate Albertans straight into the arms of the opposition — a political own-goal story with real stakes for the next election.*

- **Premier Danielle Smith's UCP** government is pushing ahead with an **independence referendum**
- New polling shows the move appears to be boosting the **Alberta NDP**, the province's main opposition
- Observers are calling it an **'unintended consequence'** of Smith's strategy to court hardline separatist-minded voters

The Debate Starter

- Could flirting with separatism actually be the thing that hands Alberta's opposition the next election?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/calgary/cbc-calgary-alberta-poll-separation-ndp-9.7367276?cmp=rss

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■ *What Florida's property tax vote means for Canadian snowbirds*

The Angle: *A huge chunk of Canadians who winter in Florida actually own property down there, so any shake-up to how the state taxes real estate hits their wallets directly — this is the kind of "wait, what does that mean for ME" story snowbird listeners will want decoded.*

The Snowbird Check-In

- Anyone in our audience own a place in Florida — are you already bracing for a bigger bill, or hoping this actually saves you money?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMioAFBVV95cUxQVUxRQWZocE5NeFV0dHNwNno4V1VuSTdya192MnhzVHpCNkF0dzY4elMzSEJXUVBNVE1YUnd4cnF5UXAxZXVLWFp5eHh5dXpMZ28wS2hpUGRKVWkyM2JKQTNzRW5YeV9OY0lwLV9JNEZKSzBialJDYTBWN25vajVQWWRHUXFKdkxlaUJGb01WWi1KYmJ3Yk9NeWhSaFFmSE1v?oc=5

■ *Art installation highlights Canada-EU ties beyond trade and defence*

The Angle: *A new art installation is being used to show the Canada-EU relationship isn't just trade deals and defense pacts - there's a cultural angle too, which gives hosts a lighter diplomatic story to chew on.*

The Quick Take

- Can a sculpture actually make us think differently about a trade partner, or is this just diplomacy with a ribbon on it?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiqgFBVV95cUxQNmo4YnJxUnJ4SDFXRTljYmRFRE9lMGozVE1HRWItY0p2QV9YTUhBc2lyMkRXVlF4SW83WHE5UjJyMFZsZjQ1R3pCMjNkYUhFeHN6UkN1SThrTjhTU3pucjk4R2drMFIzZ2VzT3ZlZDVkNzdTRXFWQzlpLWJCM2Y0eW1ZQUNHTG9QcHI0ZFA1eldrTXRGWVVXREN4NXBsamJxOVZGRWVGX1RsUQ?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Annabelle Wallis on the Defining Question of 'Unabomber,' a Potential James Wan Reunion and 'Peaky Blinders' What-Ifs - The Hollywood Reporter*

The Angle: *Annabelle Wallis sits down with THR to talk Unabomber, Peaky Blinders regrets, and a possible James Wan reunion — but the real hook is how one of her old interviews got twisted into a viral hoax about the real Annabelle doll busting out of a Connecticut museum.*

- An old **Hollywood Reporter** interview with **Annabelle Wallis** got twisted into a viral hoax claiming the real-life **Annabelle doll** escaped the **Warren Museum** in Connecticut.
- Wallis opens up on the "defining question" of playing her role in **Unabomber**.
- She teases a possible reunion with director **James Wan**, who produced the **Annabelle** horror franchise she starred in.
- Wallis also reflects on "what-ifs" from her run on **Peaky Blinders**.

The Urban Legend Hook

- A celebrity profile accidentally fueled a creepy doll-escape hoax — ask listeners if they fell for it.

Hollywood Reporter (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 90/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 33 quality) -> LEAD

URL: http://www.hollywoodreporter.com/movies/movie-features/annabelle-wallis-unabomber-netflix-1236720760/

■ *Sam Altman Says 'Artificial' Filmed Outside His House and He Waved at Andrew Garfield: 'He Did Walk Like Me … I Felt I Was in Some Weird Glitch of the Simulation'*

The Angle: *The OpenAI CEO has never actually met Andrew Garfield, who's playing him in a new movie about the chaos of his 2023 firing — but he did catch Garfield in character outside his own house, and the comparison freaked him out a little.*

- **Andrew Garfield** plays **Sam Altman** in Luca Guadagnino's upcoming film **"Artificial"**

- The movie covers the **five-day period in 2023** when Altman was abruptly fired — then reinstated — as OpenAI CEO
- Altman says he's **never met Garfield** in person, but waved at him when filming happened right outside his house
- His reaction, per **Vanity Fair**: **"He did walk like me... I felt I was in some weird glitch of the simulation."**

The Debate Starter

- Would you want to watch an actor study your walk and your worst week ever for a movie — or is that the ultimate ick?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/sam-altman-artificial-filmed-outside-house-waved-andrew-garfield-1236899020/

■ *Shocking sleazy new details surface about Grammy-winning Texas Dem candidate: 'Shhhh... it was our secret' https://t.co/CcmTlrq1ia https://t*

The Angle: *A Grammy-winning musician who's now running for office in Texas just got hit with a sleazy new exposé — that's the kind of celebrity-meets-politics mashup that's pure watercooler gold for entertainment chat.*

- **New York Post** is dropping "shocking sleazy new details" on a **Grammy-winning** candidate running for office in **Texas** as a Democrat
- The teased bombshell quote: **"Shhhh... it was our secret."**

The Gossip Grab

- A Grammy on the shelf and a scandal in the closet — does this sink a political run or just make for good tabloid theater?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2107056146431324477

■ *Sam Altman says #Artificial filmed outside his house and he waved to Andrew Garfield:*

The Angle: *The guy who's building the AI that's rattling Hollywood just had a surreal run-in with the movie about it — a lookalike actor nailed his walk, his backpack, everything, right outside his house.*

- **Sam Altman** says he stepped outside for coffee and found cameras filming **#Artificial** right on his street
- An actor dressed exactly like him — same backpack, same walk — made him feel like he was in "a weird glitch of the simulation"
- He waved to **Andrew Garfield** on set before continuing on his way
- Altman's own words: "it's like a strange thing to see someone that has nailed your kind of quirky mannerisms"

The Watercooler Moment

- Would you want to watch a stranger perfectly mimic your own mannerisms on a movie set outside your house?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2107086420309409890

Backup options:

■ *Former Special Counsel Jack Smith attends the Power to the People concert on October 3, 2026, at the Merriweather Post Pavilion in Columbia, Maryland*

The Angle: *The guy who spent years prosecuting Donald Trump as Special Counsel just showed up at a concert literally called 'Power to the People' — the internet is having a field day with the irony and the sighting itself.*

- **Jack Smith**, the former **Special Counsel** who led the federal cases against **Donald Trump**, was spotted at a concert
- The show was called **"Power to the People"**
- It happened on **October 3, 2026** at **Merriweather Post Pavilion** in **Columbia, Maryland**

The Watercooler Spot

- Celebrity sightings hit different when it's a guy who spent two years building federal cases, not a pop star — would you have recognized him in the crowd?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/lu9cy3xafhth1

■ *Zach Bryan sets the attendance record at Gillette Stadium with 73,538 people, surpassing Ed Sheeran's previous record of 71,723*

The Angle: *A country star outdrawing a global pop giant at the same stadium is exactly the kind of number that gets music fans arguing about who's really the biggest act in the world right now.*

- **Zach Bryan** packed **Gillette Stadium** with **73,538** fans.
- That tops the previous record of **71,723**, set by **Ed Sheeran**.
- The record swap puts a country artist ahead of one of pop's biggest touring acts at the same venue.

The Debate Starter

- Does this make Zach Bryan the biggest live act in music right now, bigger than Ed Sheeran?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/vg2tlgbeeith1.png

■■ *'Entourage' star Constance Zimmer reveals breast cancer battle: 'Pure shock and fear'*

The Angle: *A familiar face from 'Entourage' and 'UnREAL' going public and raw about a cancer diagnosis always lands - it's the kind of vulnerable celebrity moment that makes for real, human conversation instead of just gossip.*

- **Constance Zimmer** revealed she's battling **breast cancer**
- She described the diagnosis as "**pure shock and fear**"
- Zimmer opened up to fans on **Instagram** over the weekend, saying the mental toll that followed was "**overwhelming**"

The Real Talk Moment

- Ask listeners: when a health scare hits, is it the diagnosis or the mental spiral afterward that's actually harder to deal with?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/10/05/celebrity-news/constance-zimmer-reveals-breast-cancer-battle-details-pure-shock-and-fear-of-diagnosis/

■ *Cam Schlittler is built for surprisingly hostile environment Yankees face in Game 2*

The Angle: *The Yankees are in a must-win spot in the ALDS, and they're leaning on a guy built for exactly this kind of pressure-cooker road environment.*

- **Yankees** trail **1-0** in the best-of-five **ALDS**.
- **Game 2** is on the road in **St. Petersburg, Fla.**, described as a "hostile environment."
- **Cam Schlittler** is the Yankees' potential **Game 2 savior** on the mound.

The Debate Starter

- Do you trust a young arm to save your season on the road, or does that pressure eat rookies alive?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/05/sports/cam-schlittler-is-built-for-surprisingly-hostile-environment-yankees-face/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Don't Listen To Critics Or Rotten Tomatoes About 'Verity' - Forbes*

The Angle: *The movie version of Colleen Hoover's massively popular thriller is getting beat up by critics and sitting low on Rotten Tomatoes, but Forbes is telling fans not to trust the score — classic critics-vs-the-people fight, and Hoover's fanbase is huge enough to make this a real watercooler topic.*

- **Verity**, based on **Colleen Hoover**'s bestselling novel, is drawing harsh reviews from critics.
- A **Forbes** piece is specifically telling audiences to ignore both the critics and the **Rotten Tomatoes** score.
- Hoover's books have one of the most rabid fanbases in publishing — so a critic/fan split here tends to get loud.

The Debate Starter

- Do you trust Rotten Tomatoes before you see a movie, or do you go anyway and judge for yourself?

Forbes (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 73/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 16 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.forbes.com/sites/paultassi/2026/10/04/dont-listen-to-critics-or-rotten-tomatoes-about-verity/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Digital menstrual tracking risks creating more harm than benefit, argue experts*

The Angle: *Millions of women track their cycles on apps like Flo and Clue, but experts are warning the convenience might come with a privacy and health-risk price tag nobody read the fine print on.*

The Debate Starter

- Do you actually trust a period-tracking app with your data, or did you delete yours already?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://bmjgroup.com/digital-menstrual-tracking-risks-creating-more-harm-than-benefit-argue-experts/

Backup options:

■ *AI May Force 11 Million Workers Into New Jobs, McKinsey Says*

The Angle: *Everyone's scared AI is coming for their job, but new research says the bigger story is massive job-shuffling, not mass unemployment — which hits way closer to home for most listeners than a sci-fi robot takeover.*

- **McKinsey** projects AI could push **11 million workers** in the U.S. into entirely new occupations.
- The report's framing: AI may ultimately create more jobs than it eliminates overall.
- The catch — millions still get "left scrambling" during the transition, per the summary.

The Debate Starter

- Would you rather AI take your job outright, or force you to retrain for a totally different one?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-09-29/ai-may-force-11-million-workers-into-new-jobs-mckinsey-says

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■ *When the clocks stop changing. Research shows permanent standard time is the preferred choice for health, as it preserves morning light and aligns with human circadian biology. This can lead to improved sleep, mood, and overall health, particularly for vulnerable populations*

The Angle: *With clocks changing again soon, this is the one debate everyone has an opinion on — and new research says we've had it backwards: permanent standard time, not permanent daylight saving, is what your body actually wants.*

- **Permanent standard time** — not daylight saving — is the option researchers say your body clock actually prefers
- The big reason: it preserves **morning light**, which keeps your **circadian rhythm** on track
- Payoff includes better **sleep, mood, and overall health**
- Researchers flag it matters most for **vulnerable populations** — kids, shift workers, older adults

The Debate Starter

- Dark mornings or dark evenings — which one are you actually willing to live with forever?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN
- **Step 1: Pick Your Side** - 30 seconds, before the break -> Each host declares: Team Permanent Standard Time (bright mornings) or Team Permanent Daylight Saving (bright evenings) — no sitting on the fence.
- **Step 2: Make Your Case** - 60 seconds each -> Hosts give their best one-liner for why their side wins — commute, kids at the bus stop, after-work daylight, whatever hits hardest.
- **Step 3: Open the Phones** - Live callers decide -> Ask listeners to call/text which side they're on, and read a few out before declaring a 'winner' for the day.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/1146225

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES

■ *Bison Are Back in Britain After 6,000 Years*

The Angle: *Wild bison are roaming the UK for the first time in about 6,000 years — a genuine good-news, feel-good story about rewilding that's perfect for ending the show on a high note.*

- **European bison** have been reintroduced in **Britain** for the first time in roughly **6,000 years**.
- Marks a major rewilding milestone — these animals vanished from the UK long before recorded history.

The Feel-Good Finish
- Nothing like ending the show with giant shaggy bison just... wandering around England again.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/bison-are-back-in-britain-after-6-000-years-12077311

Backup options:

■ *In Savannah, Georgia, the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers turned 160,000 cubic yards of dredged harbor mud into an 8-acre bird island, where more than 300 nests were built in its first nesting season.*

The Angle: *A government dredging project accidentally became a conservation win — leftover harbor mud is now a packed bird colony, which is exactly the kind of 'humans did something good for once' story that closes a show on a high note.*

- The **U.S. Army Corps of Engineers** built the island out of **160,000 cubic yards** of dredged harbor mud.
- The man-made island covers **8 acres** off **Savannah, Georgia**.
- In its very first nesting season, birds already built more than **300 nests** there.

The Feel-Good Finish
- Leave it to birds to move into a brand-new island faster than most people furnish an apartment.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://dredgewire.com/savannah-turned-160000-cubic-yards-of-mud-removed-from-its-harbor-into-an-8-acre-island-birds-built-more-than-300-nests-there-in-the-first-season/

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 1/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *As She Divorces Ken Paxton, His Wife Urges Texans to Vote for Him*

The Angle: *It's the kind of political plot twist you can't make up — a soon-to-be ex-wife publicly campaigning for the guy she's splitting from, which is exactly the kind of headline that makes this community call it "not the onion."*

- **Ken Paxton's** wife is filing for divorce from him
- Despite the split, she's publicly urging Texans to still **vote for him**
- Story's blowing up on Reddit's **r/nottheonion** for being too real to be satire

The Debate Starter

- Could you publicly endorse your soon-to-be-ex for office — and would you want your ex's vote of confidence?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://archive.ph/l7AY0

■■ *Florida weighs ditching property taxes and sticking Canadians with the bill*

The Angle: *Florida's floating a plan to ditch property taxes altogether, and one idea on the table is making it up by squeezing more out of Canadian tourists and snowbirds — prime setup for a 'wait, can they even do that?' conversation.*

- **Florida** is weighing a plan to eliminate **property taxes** statewide.
- One proposed way to cover the lost revenue: lean harder on **Canadian** visitors and part-time residents.
- Florida is a top snowbird destination for Canadians, many of whom already own property there part-time.

The Debate Starter

- Is it fair game to make tourists foot the bill so locals get a tax break, or is that just asking to get banned from Canadian vacations for life?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/florida-property-taxes-canadian-snowbirds-9.7366814

■ *High school teacher fired after offering students extra credit in return for cash donations, reports say*

The Angle: *A teacher allegedly tried to turn grades into a fundraiser, offering kids extra credit if they ponied up cash donations - a classic 'wait, that actually happened?' story tailor-made for the goodbyes.*

- A **high school teacher** was reportedly **fired** over the scheme
- Students were allegedly offered **extra credit** in exchange for **cash donations**
- Reports don't specify the school or what the money was supposedly for

The Jaw-Drop

- Grades for cash - did any of you ever get offered (or offer) a sketchy extra-credit deal back in school?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.kbtx.com/2026/10/01/high-school-teacher-fired-after-offering-students-extra-credit-return-cash-donations-reports-say/

■ *Florida woman used Claude as a diary, then Anthropic reported an entry to police*

The Angle: *A Florida woman reportedly used Claude like a private journal — until Anthropic flagged one of her entries and looped in police, and now everyone's asking how private your chats with an AI chatbot actually are.*

- A **Florida woman** was reportedly using **Claude**, Anthropic's AI chatbot, as a personal diary.
- **Anthropic** flagged one of her private entries and reported it to **police**.
- Raises the question: do AI companies monitor what you type into a chatbot — and when do they call the authorities?

The Debate Starter

- Would you still vent to an AI chatbot knowing it might call the cops on you?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/114091-florida-woman-used-claude-diary-anthropic-reported-shoot.html

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■■ *People are asking ChatGPT to help them decide how to vote in the midterms*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): AI-assisted voting decisions is a novel, trend-aligned angle that will only get more newsworthy as the midterms approach.
The Angle: *Midterms are coming up and apparently some voters are outsourcing the decision to a chatbot — it's a weirdly perfect snapshot of 2026 and an easy debate-starter for the show.*

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever let an AI tell you who to vote for — or is that where you draw the line?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.npr.org/2026/10/05/nx-s1-5977852/ai-chatbots-midterm-election

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■■ *Iranian strikes on AWS facilities left customer data beyond recovery in Bahrain, UAE*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Physical strikes disabling AWS infrastructure and destroying customer data is a major cloud-security/geopolitical story that should be drawing far more attention than it currently has.
The Angle: *This isn't just a server outage — if Iranian strikes actually nuked AWS data centers in Bahrain and the UAE beyond recovery, that's a wake-up call on how fragile "the cloud" really is when it sits in a war zone.*

- Report claims Iranian strikes hit **AWS facilities** in **Bahrain** and the **UAE**
- Customer data from those facilities is described as **beyond recovery**
- Story is circulating out of **r/technology** on Reddit, details still thin/unverified

The Reality Check

- If "the cloud" can get bombed, is anything you store online actually safe?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/17/aws-middle-east-outage-permanent-data-loss-bahrain-uae/

■ *Scott Bessent compares AI CEOs who warn of catastrophe to Hannibal Lecter: 'Stop me before I kill again'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A sitting Treasury Secretary comparing AI CEOs to Hannibal Lecter is an unusually vivid, quotable soundbite from a named government official that's built for clipping and sharing.
The Angle: *Scott Bessent just compared AI chiefs who publicly warn their own tech could be catastrophic to a fictional serial killer begging to be stopped — a wild, quotable jab from a sitting cabinet official that cuts right at Silicon Valley's favorite PR move.*

- **Scott Bessent**, the sitting **U.S. Treasury Secretary**, made the comparison.
- He likened **AI CEOs** who warn their technology could be catastrophic to **Hannibal Lecter**.
- The line invoked: **"Stop me before I kill again."**
- The jab targets the irony of tech leaders both building AI and sounding alarms about it.

The Debate Starter

- Is 'doomer' talk from AI CEOs genuine warning or just genius marketing dressed up as a confession?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/scott-bessent-compares-ai-ceos-seeking-regulation-to-hannibal-lecter-2026-10

■ *Robert Blake’s Son Stages Murder Mystery at Restaurant Tied to Wife’s Murder*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A true-crime-adjacent, darkly bizarre stunt (a murder mystery dinner staged at the restaurant tied to his mother's real murder) has the kind of macabre novelty that drives true-crime audiences to share.
The Angle: *Robert Blake's murder trial over wife Bonny Lee Bakley's 2001 killing was one of the biggest tabloid sagas of its era, so his son staging a murder-mystery dinner at the very restaurant tied to that case is the kind of wild, real-life-meets-true-crime stunt that gets people talking.*

- **Robert Blake's son** organized a staged murder mystery event
- The event was held at a **restaurant directly tied to his stepmother's real-life murder**
- Blake himself was famously tried (and acquitted) in **Bonny Lee Bakley's 2001 shooting death**

The Debate Starter

- Is this a tasteless cash-grab or a weirdly clever way to turn tragedy into tribute?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://parade.com/entertainment/robert-blakes-son-stages-murder-mystery-at-restaurant-tied-to-wifes-murder

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■ *‘Avengers: Endgame’ Overtakes ‘Avatar’ as Highest-Grossing Movie in History With $2.925 Billion After ‘Encore’ Re-Release*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Endgame reclaiming the all-time box office crown via a surprise re-release is a nameable, fan-mobilizing milestone for one of the largest built-in fandoms in entertainment.
The Angle: *The two biggest movies ever made are STILL fighting for the all-time box office title years later, and this time Marvel pulled off the win with a sneaky move: dragging fans back into theaters for a re-release.*

- **Avengers: Endgame** has now crossed **$2.925 billion** worldwide, making it the highest-grossing movie of all time.
- The record-breaking boost came from a new theatrical **"Encore" re-release**, not just its original 2019 run.
- **Avatar** held the all-time crown before this, and the two films have now traded the title back and forth for years.

The Debate Starter

- Should a re-release be allowed to 'break' an all-time box office record, or is that just a nostalgia cash grab?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/box-office/avengers-endgame-highest-grossing-movie-ever-avatar-1236894787/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)
- "VMAs 2026 best and worst moments: Dolly Parton tributes, Madonna’s bizarre speeches" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Hundreds of lefties link arms for bizarre ‘hands across the sand’ protest against California oil drilling" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-28)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 13 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)

- "'The Visit' at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The '50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)
- "Neil Patrick Harris to Star in 'Damn Yankees' Broadway Revival" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris and Julianne Hough to Lead First Broadway Revival of Damn Yankees in Over 30 Years - People.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-27)
- "Neil Patrick Harris Will Lead Damn Yankees Broadway Revival Spring 2027 - Playbill" (Playbill.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-09-28)
- "Kawhi Leonard has fun with Ka'Wine & Dine revival at Raptors media day: 'I can't eat as much'" (Toronto Star (via Google News), banked 2026-09-29)
- "Less than two weeks shy of the one-year anniversary of 'The Life of a Showgirl,' Taylor Swift surprised fans by releasing four bonus tracks " (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-29)
- "SteelSeries brings ultra-wideband wireless to gaming mice, chasing lag-free tracking" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-30)
- "A top QB showdown and a historic anniversary: 5 things to know from the NFL this week - CNN" (CNN (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-02)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 1 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 4 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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